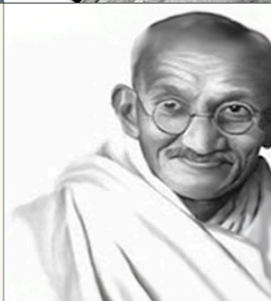


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Portuguese



Portuguese

- **The Portuguese presence in India lasted for over 400 years and left a lasting impact on Indian society.**
- **The Portuguese introduced new technologies, architectural styles, and cooking techniques to India.**
- **However, their legacy in India is also marked by violence and exploitation.**

- **The Arrival Of Portuguese In India**

- **By the late 15th century, Portugal was a dominant naval force in Europe, eager to establish trade routes with India, known for its wealth and luxury goods.**
- **In 1497, Portuguese navigator Vasco da Gama embarked on a journey to find a sea route to India. After a long voyage, he reached Calicut (modern-day Kozhikode) on India's southwest coast in May 1498.**
- **The Portuguese arrival in India was met with mixed responses. Some Indian rulers saw them as potential allies, while others perceived them as a threat.**
- **Realizing that force was necessary to establish a foothold, Vasco da Gama led a military expedition against Calicut in 1502, burning the city and destroying its fleet.**
- **In 1503, the Portuguese set up their first trading post in India at Cochin (now Kochi), marking the beginning of their dominance in the region.**
- **Over the following decades, the Portuguese expanded their presence, establishing trading posts along India's west coast, including Goa, which became the capital of Portuguese India.**
- **Although the Portuguese attempted to establish footholds on the east coast of India, they faced strong resistance from local rulers.**
- **The rise of the Portuguese in India was a significant milestone in the early phase of European colonization, reflecting the interconnectedness of world history during this era.**

- Timeline of Portuguese

Year	Event
1498	Vasco da Gama lands in Calicut
1503	The first Portuguese fort was established at Cochin
1505	The second Portuguese fort was built at Cannanore
1509	The Portuguese defeated the combined fleet of Egyptians, Arabs, and Zamorins at the Battle of Diu
1510	Goa was captured by Alfonso de Albuquerque
1530	Goa was declared the capital of Portuguese India
1535	Diu completely subjugated
1539	Portuguese victory in the Siege of Diu
1559	Daman was captured by the Portuguese
1596	Dutch establish dominance in the spice trade in South-East Asia
1612	Surat lost to the English
1661	Bombay handed over to the English
1663	The Portuguese lost all Malabar Coast forts to the Dutch
1779	Acquisition of Dadra and Nagar Haveli
1843	Panjim becomes the capital of Portuguese India
1961	Indian military operation liberates Goa, Daman, and Diu

- Portuguese with the **leader Vasco da Gama** arrived with three ships at Calicut in **1498 AD**.



- In 1503 AD, the **first Portuguese fort at Cochin** was established.
- It was the period which witnessed the **spice trade**.
- **Colonies of Portuguese:**
 - Calicut, Cochin, Goa, San Thome, Diu, Daman.

● **Bartholomeu Diaz-[FIRST ATTEMPT]**

- In **1487 AD**, he became the first Portuguese sailor to embark on a voyage to explore new trade routes.
- He reached the **southernmost tip of Africa** during his journey.
- Due to a storm encountered at this point, he initially named it the Cape of Storms.
- Later, the cape was renamed the Cape of Good Hope, symbolizing the optimism of discovering a sea route to India.



● **Vasco da Gama:**

- **First Portuguese** to visit India.
- His visit is considered as the '**start of the new era of the world**'.
- He **first landed at Calicut in 1498 AD**.
- He later built factories at Cochin and Cannanore.
- **During his time, Calicut, Cochin, and Cannanore became potential trade centres for the Portuguese.**



- During his time, the Portuguese got **permission to fortify their trade centres.**
- **Francisco Almeida:**
- He came to India to **consolidate the position of the Portuguese and destroy the Muslim trade centres.**
- Also, he wanted to **destroy the Muslim trade by seizing Aden, Hormuz, and Malacca straits.**
- Hence, he **started the blue water policy** to become a **master of the Indian Ocean trade.**

Point To Remember:

Bluewater policy:

- The policy, aimed to **control the Indian Ocean region** and establish dominance over sea.



Alfonso de Albuquerque:

- He was called the **real founder of Portuguese power** in the East.
- He built up many **ship industries** in India.
- He **controlled almost all the Indian Ocean trade regions.**
- He **captured Goa from the Sultan of Bijapur** in 1510 AD.
- He was very **bitter to the Muslims.**
- He **abolished the Sati system.**
- He **encouraged Portuguese men to have Indian wives.**
- In Goa, he **built new roads and irrigated works.**
- He introduced **new crops like tobacco, cashew nuts, and various varieties of coconut.**



Nino da Cunha:

- He **shifted the capital from Cochin to Goa** in 1530 AD.
- **Diu and Bassein** were captured by the Gujarat king named Bahadur Shah.



- He also attempted to **increase Portuguese influence in Bengal** by settling many Portuguese nationals with **Hugli as their headquarters**.
- He allowed **religious teachers called Jesuits** to encourage local people to convert to **Christianity**.
- His reign was **marked by the emergence of Naval power**.
- The speciality of his military administration was there was a **system of drill for groups of infantry**.

Decline of Portuguese :

- By the **end of the 17th century**, the Portuguese in India lost their commercial influence.
- Portuguese were completely **ousted by the Dutch** and **one of** all the ports on the Malabar coast in 1663 AD.
- **Portuguese dominated Surat in the 16th century till 1530 AD**. Later other trading groups like French, Armenians, English, Dutch and Turks were sharing the space until the first trading factory by the English was set up in 1612 AD.
- Their religious policy like **the activities of Jesuits** and antagonism against Muslims and Hindus made Hindus and Muslims resentful against them.
- **Piracy at various places** encouraged by the Portuguese antagonized Mughal rulers like Shajahan. This led to several wars against the Portuguese.